

Seawall height in Hallandale Beach

The elevation your city requires, the datum it is measured in, and the section of code that says so.

HALLANDALE BEACH • BROWARD COUNTY

5.0

 ft NAVD88

New, substantially repaired or substantially rehabilitated seawalls in Hallandale Beach must reach at least 5.0 ft NAVD88. Applications filed before 1 Jan 2035 can be approved at 4.0 ft NAVD88 if the wall is designed to be raised to 5.0 ft by 2050. The city code sets no maximum seawall height.

The detail

MINIMUM	5.0 ft NAVD88 - Code Sec. 8-90(a)
INTERIM	Applications submitted before 1 Jan 2035 may be permitted at 4.0 ft NAVD88 if designed and constructed to accommodate 5.0 ft NAVD88 by 1 Jan 2050 - Sec. 8-90(a)
APPLIES TO	new tidal flood barriers and substantial repair/rehab; not oceanfront seaward of the CCCL - Sec. 8-89
SIDE CONTAINMENT	owners must add side containment barriers as needed to keep rainwater on their property - Sec. 8-90(c)
WHOLE SHORELINE	substantial repair/rehab must cover the entire shoreline - Sec. 8-90(f)
ADOPTED	Ord. No. 2020-030, 18 Nov 2020 - Sec. 8-89 to 8-91
SELLING	Owners and buyers must follow the Broward County Code Sec. 39-408 tidal-area disclosure in sale contracts - Sec. 8-91
CONDO CONVERSIONS	Before rental units are sold as condominiums, the owner's certificate-of-compliance application must list any known seawall defects or deficiencies, and a licensed building contractor must certify the repairs - Sec. 8-111(c)(5), (d)
THE CITY'S CALL	No seawall is required where, in the city's opinion, other flood protection does the job just as well - Sec. 8-90(i)

Where this comes from: Hallandale Beach Code of Ordinances Ch. 8, Art. III, Div. 3, Sec. 8-90 (Ord. No. 2020-030); Secs. 8-91 and 8-111

Verified: 2026-10. Rules change — check the date above against today.

Before you call a contractor

1 Know your datum

A height means nothing without the datum it is measured from. NAVD88 and MLW are different reference points and the same wall gives different numbers in each. Ask which one any quoted elevation refers to.

2 Get the existing elevation surveyed

You cannot tell whether a wall meets the requirement by looking at it. A surveyor shooting the top of the cap settles it in an hour.

3 Ask what triggers the requirement

Most cities only apply the minimum to new walls or to substantial repair. What counts as substantial is defined differently in each city, and it is usually a percentage of length or of cost.

4 Ask about building higher now

Several cities require a wall built below the final figure to be engineered so it can be raised later. Doing it once is cheaper than doing it twice.